

FROM DESK TO DAIS

Sa far, familiar with implementing policy, these former bureaucrats will now have an inside view of the legislative process itself



▲ G. KUMAR NAIK, 60

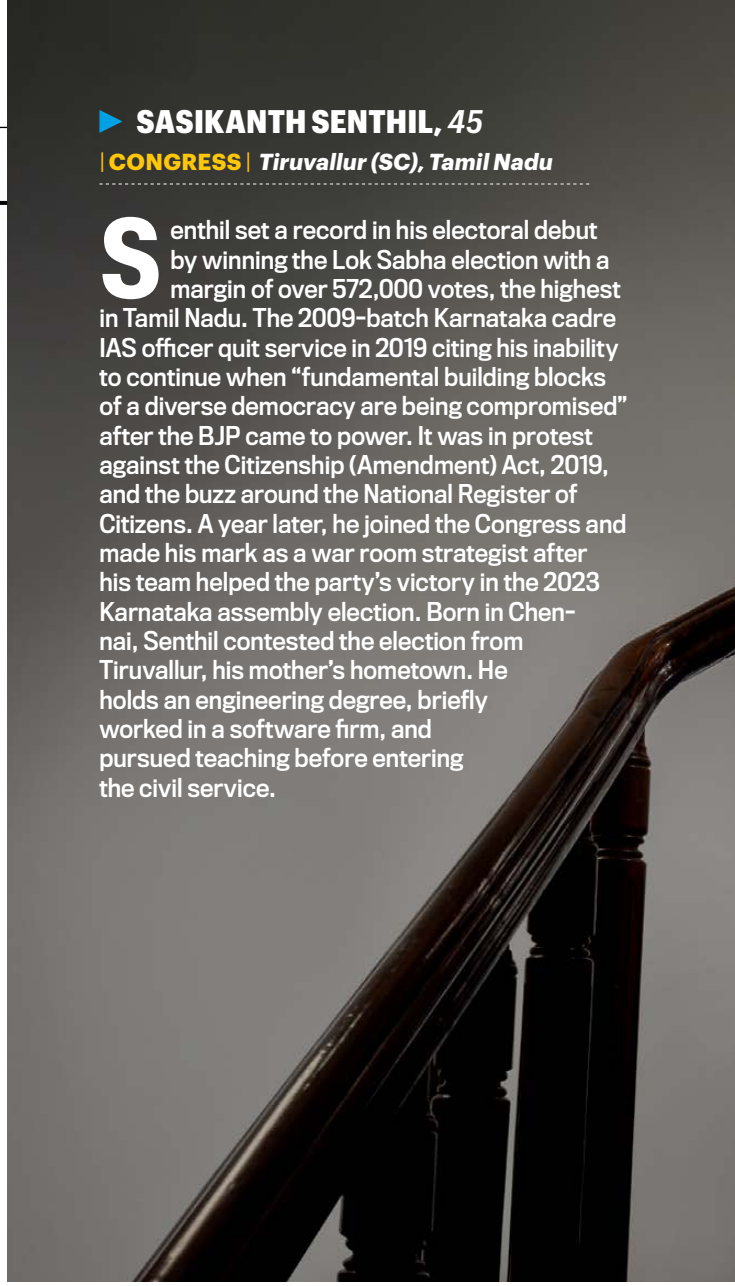
| CONGRESS | ***Raichur (ST), Karnataka***

The 1990-batch IAS officer, who retired from service in September 2023 as the Bangalore Development Authority commissioner, served as deputy commissioner of Raichur between 1999 and 2002. Now, representing the seat in Parliament, he faces a far bigger challenge. Part of the Kalyana Karnataka region, Raichur is an economically backward area of the state, facing significant healthcare disparities. Bringing an AIIMS campus there is chief among Naik's goals.

▶ SASIKANTH SENTHIL, *45*

| CONGRESS | ***Tiruvallur (SC), Tamil Nadu***

Senthil set a record in his electoral debut by winning the Lok Sabha election with a margin of over 572,000 votes, the highest in Tamil Nadu. The 2009-batch Karnataka cadre IAS officer quit service in 2019 citing his inability to continue when "fundamental building blocks of a diverse democracy are being compromised" after the BJP came to power. It was in protest against the Citizenship (Amendment) Act, 2019, and the buzz around the National Register of Citizens. A year later, he joined the Congress and made his mark as a war room strategist after his team helped the party's victory in the 2023 Karnataka assembly election. Born in Chennai, Senthil contested the election from Tiruvallur, his mother's hometown. He holds an engineering degree, briefly worked in a software firm, and pursued teaching before entering the civil service.



MANNA LAL RAWAT, 52 ▶

| BJP | ***Udaipur (ST), Rajasthan***

His tenure as the additional transport commissioner in Udaipur made him a familiar face among the tribal communities. His deep involvement in the activities of the RSS and its tribal wing, the Vanvasi Kalyan Parishad, only cemented that influence. Keeping a low profile did not help, as the BJP took notice of his work and nominated him from the ST-reserved constituency. Rawat, who holds a Vidya Vachaspati (equivalent to a PhD) and has a post-graduate degree in public administration, defeated another ex-bureaucrat–IAS officer Tara Chand Meena of the Congress.

